

5.6 Gazing Into the Crystal Ball...

So what does the future hold for gaming? Well, the possibilities are limitless. Games are a dime-a-dozen and there are always a couple of good games around the block. PC hardware too is always being improved upon, with faster, bigger, more powerful components being announced everyday. As the joke goes- The rate of advancements is so fast that your hardware might turn obsolete as you read this!

Consoles are where things get interesting. All the major players in the console business have recently revealed their next-gen consoles, sparking off the so-called 'console wars'. Microsoft with their Xbox 360 and Sony with their Playstation 3 are going to be the major players in the industry, with Nintendo and it's Revolution having to be satisfied with a bit-part role.

Apart from the good looks, it's the hardware specs for each system that has captured the imagination of gamers worldwide. And it's not difficult to see why. The Xbox 360 has a CPU with three IBM PowerPC 3.2Ghz cores, ATI 500MHz graphics processor, 48 billion shader operations per second, 512Mb GDDR3 RAM of memory, Removable and upgradeable 20Gb hard drive, Three USB ports and support for DVD-video, DVD-ROM, DVD-R, DVD+R, CD-DA, CD-R, WMA CD, MP3 CD, Jpeg photo CD. Overall, Microsoft claims this will give a teraflop of performance.

That's quite a package and literally the stuff gaming dreams are made of. What really has everyone drooling though is the Playstation 3. It gives you a CPU Cell Processor running at 3.2 GHz with 7 special purpose 3.2 GHz processors, capable of 218, count them, 218 gigaflops of performance, Backward compatible, GPU RSX at 550MHz 1.8 teraflop floating point performance, 256Mb XDR main RAM at 3.2 GHz, 256Mb of GDDR VRAM at 700Mhz, Memory Stick Duo, SD, compact flash memory slots, Detachable 2.5 inch hard drive, Support for seven Bluetooth controllers, Six USB slots for peripherals, Supports Blu-ray DVD format, System